

MINUTES

An **Evaluation Subcommittee Meeting** is held **June 01, 2023**, scheduled from 5pm - 6pm. The meeting is held via remote participation on Zoom and viewed through Medford Community Media on Comcast Channel 15 and Verizon Channel 45.

MEMORANDUM

As approved by the Committee on February 1, 2023 (2023-3): The Evaluation Subcommittee will meet to review and develop the process for the 2022-23 Superintendent Evaluation

AGENDA

As approved by the Evaluation Subcommittee on Thursday February 16, 2023, and a continuation from May 24, 2023, the Subcommittee meets to finalize the composite evaluation for the superintendent.

Tonight's meeting is the review and develop the process for 2022/2023 Superintendent Evaluation. As approved on Monday May 24, 2023, this meeting is a continuation of the last meeting where the subcommittee began the process of putting together a composite review for the Superintendent.

Chair/Member Hays: hands off the chair to Member McLaughlin for the meeting

Member McLaughlin: chairs and opens the meeting

Roll Call: All subcommittee members present. (Member Hays, Member McLaughlin, Member Graham) - 3/0

Public Participants: unknown

Member Graham explains to those listening or watching, that in the last meeting (May 24), the process was started by taking the seven independent (draft input) reviews as completed by the school committee members and started looking at how to aggregate those reviews into a single review. The final review of the superintendent has to be reviewed by the school committee and one review that is recorded and represents the view of the school committee via a majority vote. Tonight, the subcommittee will go through the draft that Member Hays compiled to say what we think this composite review should look like. She thanks Member Hays for doing "such a fabulous job" putting the review together.

Member Graham continues and shares the template that members used to fill out their draft comments and speaks to the data thereon:

Slide 1: End-of-Cycle Summative Evaluation Report: Superintendent

What is seen at the top of the screen is Step1: Assess Progress Toward Goals

Seen at the top is the summary of the 3 goals that were outline and approved by the school committee in the Fall (2022) as set out by the subcommittee in the Fall:

- Professional Practice Goal(s)
- Student Learning Goal(s)
- District Improvement Goal(s)

The numbers seen represent the actual evaluation rankings from all seven (7) members of the school committee. Tallied across, they equal 7 in all cases. What needs to be done is to determine what the recommendation for the committee wide answer will be for each of these goals. What you can see for each of these goals, the majority of feedback from the committee was 'met', which is why it shows in red. She recommends the subcommittee members go through the document section by section and agree on the final composite for each.

- Student Learning Goal(s) - the majority of the committee felt that was 'met'.
- District Improvement Goal(s) - there was a little more variety. 3 reflected significant progress, 1 that identified 'met' as the ranking and 1 that identified 'exceeded'.

Member McLaughlin asks for a Point of Information with regard to the District Improvement Goals and points out that it shows as '3'.

Member Graham confirms that District Improvement Goals was 3 for 'significant improvement' 3 for 'met' and 1 for exceeded. She believes the draft recommendation that we (the subcommittee) need to weigh in on consensus, whether we (the subcommittee) agree that 'met' is the right ranking for the committee's evaluation of the superintendent in all cases. She pauses and asks for comments.

Member McLaughlin comments on the 'met' ranking and hopes the superintendent will look at these numbers well as she knows others will, even where there was some variation. There was one 'exceeded' ranking, so it is on the right side of 'met'. She personally feels that 'met' is appropriate for each of these goals, with some outliers.

Member Graham asks to take a roll call vote to ensure all are in agreement.

Motion to approve the progress towards goals as 'met' for the summary evaluation report for the Superintendent by Member McLaughlin; seconded by Member Hays.

Motion carries unanimously 3/0

Member Graham confirms that 'met' is the ranking that will be brought forward to the school committee for Step 1 Professional Practice, Student Learning and District Improvement goals.

Step Two - Assess Performance on Standards

This is a summary of Assess Performance on Standards and a roll-up of what each of the seven (7) members thought of the Superintendent's performance across the four (4) pillars that DESE requires to evaluate her on. Each pillar was gone through and the performance standards and identify focus indicators preselected by the committee, who evaluated these rankings and evaluations, based on those particular focus indicators.

- Standard 1: Instructional Leadership: all seven (7) members are in agreement that 'proficient' was the correct ranking.
- Standard II: Management & Operations: two (2) members commented 'needs improvement'; five (5) noted proficient.
- Standard III: Family, Community Engagement: one (1) member noted 'needs improvement' and six (6) who said 'proficient'.
- Standard IV: Professional Culture: one (1) noted 'needs improvement' and six (6) noted 'proficient'.

Motion to accept 'proficient' as the standard for all four (4) of the Standards in Step 2 made by Member McLaughlin; seconded by Member Hays.

Motion carries unanimously 3/0

Member Graham continues to share her screen -

Step 3: Rate Overall Summative Performance

These are evaluation comments that are based on all of the things (rankings) agreed to in Step 1 and Step 2 and what the overall summative performance ranking is for the Superintendent. Agreed by unanimous opinion, 'proficient' ranking is the ranking that will go to DESE, provided there is agreement on Monday night (School Committee Meeting of June 5, 2023). No vote is needed and all are in favor of this decision.

Step 4: Evaluator Comments

This is where the committee has an opportunity to provide (overall) comments. Member Graham allows the committee to read through the comments. These are not all the comments. Member Hays went through all the reviews and pulled out what she believed to be some salient comments that she recommends bringing forward as part of the official comments on the final review from the school committee.

Comments:

The Medford School Committee rated Superintendent Edouard-Vincent's overall performance to be 'Proficient'

Following are excerpts from members who provided comments.

Member Kreatz: Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent has demonstrated she has exceeded all her goals as described in her key actions and outcomes. Some of the key actions/outcomes that caught my eye were: engaging the vocational students to build the bicycle racks and will install them; launch of a new district smartphone app for the MPS Website and Google Calendar; communication platform used by all schools and student servicing groups Talking Points; listening sessions; arts added to the 9th grade CTE rotation. It is a pleasure working collaboratively with Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent. There are many positive things taking place in all our schools. She encourages learning and growth for ALL students. She makes herself present at each school for various events and she is at community events engaged with parents/caregivers and students.

Mayor/Chair Lungo-Koehn: When I think of professional culture I think of it in terms of accountability. I think the administration does a good job on overall staffing, but I don't see the culture changing the way it should on a higher level. Performance evaluations, progressive discipline, goal setting, performance management plans, and accountability help make an organization stronger. Those who are willing to improve and accept it thrive and those who do not prove in the end that changes need to be made.

Member McLaughlin: Dr. EV's performance is proficient with some work to do in areas such as managing conflict and including all learners in instructional leadership. We are fortunate to have Dr. EV as our Superintendent, especially during such difficult times including, but not limited to, emerging from a global pandemic and continuing to cope with the behavioral health crisis all schools are experiencing. Dr. EV is always willing to roll up her sleeves and move the work forward.

Member Graham asks for any questions, comments or suggested edits on the form - and feedback.

Member McLaughlin is curious and unclear about the process and not sure the subcommittee had discussed having a narrative. She's not sure if it's not too long. Suggests the subcommittee take a look at the rest (of the document) and come back to this question.

Member Graham responds that this is the draft recommendation and it would serve as the composite. She recommends continuing through the rest of the comments before determining if changes (if any) need to be made to any of them. She points out that comments for instructional leadership are at the bottom of the page and throughout one can see the distribution as to how the members evaluated the superintendent on the various focus indicators - which show in yellow. The comments are at the bottom for Standard 1, Instructional Leadership

Member McLaughlin asks Member Graham if one is able to see more than just the 2 that she sees and

on the previous one (page?) she only saw 3.

Member Graham confirms that is all that is there.

Member Hays comments that if a committee member added a comment, she included it. If there are only two or three comments, only two or three members made a comment on that particular area.

Comments:

On Standard I Instructional Leadership, the Medford School Committee rated Superintendent Edouard-Vincent's performance to be Proficient.

Following are excerpts from members who provided comments.

Member Hays: Dr. E-V has continued to implement and support a wide variety of curriculum for diverse learning needs and interests, including the new K-5 math program, the MHS Integrated Math Pathway, a new 9th grade arts/music rotation, and a new K-5 literacy core program for 2023-24. The lack of specific data regarding the implementation of new initiatives make it difficult to fully assess success. Next year, I would like Dr. Edouard-Vincent to provide more specific data to the school committee.

Member McLaughlin: Not sure how much work is being done on personalized learning and universal design. It is unclear how the Superintendent sets high expectations for our subgroups such as English Learners and Students with Disabilities.

Member Graham shares the next page -

Standard II: Management & Operations

There were comments from four (4) members on this section. According to DESE guidelines, comments are required if anything but 'Proficient' is selected. Anyone who selected 'proficient' is not required to provide comments, although it is encouraged that comments are provided.

Comments:

On Standard II Management & Operations, the Medford School Committee rated Superintendent Edouard-Vincent's performance to be Proficient.

Following are excerpts from members who provided comments.

Member Hays: Dr. Edouard-Vincent has made progress in a number of areas related to Management & Operations. Highlights include implementing clear and efficient processes for hiring 3 new principals; implementation of the MHS safety action plan; and hiring a consultant to assess the climate and culture at MHS. The consultant detailed a number of significant concerns to address at the high school in the area of Management & Operations. Member McLaughlin: While there is work to do in this area, having a strategic plan with clear goals is helpful in demonstrating the development and execution of an effective plan. There remains a good deal of systems level work to do especially in a system where there had previously been one leader for more than 25 years.

Member Mustone: Dr. Edouard-Vincent is an engaged and dedicated superintendent. She has worked tirelessly on early literacy with teachers and staff, communication with families, and student's social and emotional resources. My evaluation scores were "proficient" in 3 out of 4 categories as proficient, with the only "needs improvement" score being for Management and Operations. With her commitment to academics, sometimes recommendations, policies, and procedures are put on the back burner. Moving forward, my hope is that the implementation of the recommendations of our consultants Cyndi Weekes Bradley and Michael Welch will help to improve this.

Member Ruseau: Medford Public Schools system is lacking in many systems that would improve student outcomes. While the Superintendent has overseen some improvements in the use of systematic

approaches to the work of the district, non-existent systems that are common in other districts remain numerous. There is no evidence that the creation of the following systems has been undertaken: modernized human resource system that, among other things, integrates with a modern financial system to provide monthly personnel reports; staff feedback system on discipline, as required by an October 2020 resolution; school committee tracker for resolutions and motions to be publicly available on the district website, as required by a March 2022 resolution (SC rule 88); maintenance and facility tracking system; and communications systems that would provide for reliable, repeatable, and robust utilization under normal operational and emergent scenarios. No communications system has been purchased, and we remain fully limited by the knowledge of presently employed individuals, leaving us open to system failures and single points of failure.

Standard III: Family and Community Engagement

Comments:

On Standard III Family and Community Engagement, the Medford School Committee rated Superintendent Edouard-Vincent's performance to be Proficient.

Following are excerpts from members who provided comments.

Member Hays: Dr. Edouard-Vincent has made improvements this year in engaging families and stakeholders through the implementation of a new district website and smartphone app; district-wide use of the Talking Points app; and additions to her weekly email to families. Engagement in the form of consistent, proactive two-way communication continues to be an area of significant need in MPS, a need which has been documented in consultant reports, school committee meetings, and in last year's evaluation of the superintendent.

Member Kreatz: She makes herself present at each school for various events and she is at community events engaged with parents/caregivers and students. Throughout the school year, she encountered some difficult times at MHS. She addressed the issues with parents/caregivers and the student body. She swiftly implemented a comprehensive and safe re-opening plan, a Ten-Point Action plan. She has committed to continue to improve the climate at MHS. One of her highest priorities is the safety and well-being of the students, teachers, administrators, families, and community.

Mayor/Chair Lungo-Koehn: Communication with families, caregivers and the school committee is very good. Work is needed in crisis communications as well as fact checking information before it is put out.

Member McLaughlin: Dr. EV does a good job with her superintendent comments at making families of all backgrounds feel welcome in our community. She is approachable. She sends out weekly communication to families and the community. We have an opportunity to be more than proficient in this area. Especially with DESE's focus on family engagement as an indicator. We have work to do on ensuring all materials are accessible as are all buildings.

Standard IV: Professional Culture

Member McLaughlin comments that this is managing conflict.

Member Graham confirms that the two (2) focus indicators are cultural proficiency and managing conflict.

Comments:

On Standard IV Professional Culture, the Medford School Committee rated Superintendent Edouard-Vincent's performance to be Proficient.

Following are excerpts from members who provided comments.

Member Graham: This has been a difficult year for central administration on many fronts. Looking forward, the Superintendent should work hard to proactively create structures and systems that allow

MPS to avoid challenging situations and deteriorating culture wherever possible.

Member Hays: Dr Edouard-Vincent has high expectations for teaching and learning, and these expectations are clearly and consistently shared with all stakeholders. Managing conflict is an area of ongoing challenge, as indicated in the MHS Climate and Culture report by consultant Michael Welch.

Member Kreatz: Throughout the school year, she encountered some difficult times at MHS. She addressed the issues with parents/caregivers and the student body and swiftly implemented a comprehensive and safe re-opening plan, a Ten-Point Action plan. She has committed to continue to improve the climate at MHS. One of her highest priorities is the safety and well-being of the students, teachers, administrators, families, and community.

Member McLaughlin: Dr. EV clearly has a commitment to high standards and cultural proficiency. Our district, like many, has experienced its fair share of conflict these past few years. While we have all learned a good deal about managing conflict we all need improvement in this area.

Member Graham returns to the top of the document/form and shows the comments about the overall performance which we have agreed are proficient. The question is, are there any edits or changes to be made to any of these?

Member McLaughlin says no; she likes seeing the comments in context and seeing the variety in the comments. She appreciates Member Hays thoughtfully putting these together. She recommends the comments stay throughout. They are helpful and provide background. She appreciates when colleagues use specific examples and thinks she could do that a little more in future evaluations. She comments that Member Hays and Member Kreatz were both particularly good at that. She elects for them to remain.

Member Graham agrees. Some of what is nice about the variety is a recognition that we all have different perspectives on what we see. Even though the goal is for us (the school committee) to have one voice, that one voice comes through a majority vote and that means there are seven (7) members who all have something different in their experience that they had or had observed in different areas of focus that make them particularly interested in certain things. She did not think that any of the comments didn't belong and felt they were all appropriate.

Motion to accept the draft (evaluator) comments as written throughout by Member McLaughlin; seconded by Member Graham.
Motion Carries 3/0

Member Graham comments that what this means is that the subcommittee has agreed to all of the components of this review, as written. Next steps would be to make a motion to recommend that the committee accepts and supports the review as written. It will then be discussed at the next meeting of the school committee on Monday, June 5, 2023.

Member McLaughlin makes further comments. The process as it was laid out, was particularly helpful and thanks Member Hays for thinking about how this could be done using the DESE Form, and modifying it to personalize it for the Medford District. It keeps a certain standard and a good example of an evaluative process. She acknowledges the Superintendent's presence and even though this (review) will be discussed on Monday (June 5, 2023), asks that if appropriate, the Superintendent has anything to say or had any thoughts on the process as compared to the past.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent comments that the process is clear and the committee is working collaboratively. It has provided her with an opportunity to send feedback, make some revisions and send additional data if necessary. She will look at the feedback more closely once she receives it and be better prepared to respond on Monday.

Motion to accept the Superintendent Evaluation as the committee has reviewed and recommended the (school) committee do the same in the meeting next week (Monday June 5, 2023); seconded by Member Graham.

Motion Carries unanimously 3/0

Member Graham confirms the review will be submitted for consideration by the Committee.

Motion to adjourn by Member Hays; seconded by Member Graham

Motion carries unanimously 3/0

Meeting adjourns: 5:25pm